

Recherche Tech Uses Open Source Technologies to Power Education in India

Recherche Tech LLP, a three-year-old software company based in Ahmedabad, Gujarat, is striving to take the lead in applying innovative, affordable and inclusive open source solutions in the educational segment. Its first commercial product is 'My sCool Server', a unique all-in-one education technology solution built using open source technologies. Ideal for schools, colleges and trainers, My sCool Server is a feature-packed device for powering computer labs, smart classrooms and offline content e-libraries.

It is packaged with some of the best free educational tools available such as Sugar, GCompris, the early math content of Khan Academy, as well as several engaging open source games and colourful storybooks from Pratham.

In an exclusive interview with the *OSFY Bureau*, **Jigish Gohil, co-founder and chief product architect, Recherche Tech LLP**, talks about the product, the company's sales strategy, the open source ecosystem, and how the firm built a business around it.

Q. Tell us more about your company. When and how did the My sCool Server journey begin?

A. Founded in 2016, Recherche Tech is recognised as a startup by the Department of Industrial Promotion and Policy, Ministry of Commerce & Industry, government of India under the Startup India initiative. Soon after the company was founded, My sCool Server was validated as an innovative product by the incubation centre at the National Institute of Design (NID), Ahmedabad.

The company's name is derived from the French word *Recherché*. It is an adjective, the literal meaning for which is 'rare, exotic or obscure'.

True to its name, Recherche Tech LLP was set up with the sole purpose of unearthing exotic and obscure technologies with the help of deep research. We innovate with these technologies, to create products and solutions for ICT in education, which will benefit the masses.



Jigish Gohil, co-founder and chief product architect, Recherche Tech LLP

Social impact is one of our core concerns. We aim to bring the benefits of technology in education to the maximum number of schools possible, in a most cost-effective manner. We help schools leverage technology

that allows them to continue using hardware they have already invested in, reduce their carbon footprint, and save on Internet bandwidth by providing rich content for students, even without going online.

My sCool Server is a result of over a decade's experience in building education focused GNU/Linux distributions, and working closely with teachers and students to do so.

Earlier, I had created a solution called 'Li-f-e: Linux for Education', which was built on openSUSE and was being used by the Indonesian government school system nationwide. This was backed by my expertise in Linux Terminal Server Project (LTSP), and even received the FOSS India Award from *Open Source For You* magazine. We saw that there was a need for something that was easy to deploy, irrespective of the school's computer lab set-up, but the solution also needed to provide quality offline content and